INDIANA STRATEGIC SITES INVENTORY (SSI) PROGRAM · DECISION BRIEF

Finish the job: the case for reinvesting in SSI

Indiana has paid for the slow part, discovering and ranking 1,811 sites in 92 counties, and stopped before the fast part: due diligence, site control, and graduation to market. Competing states now spend hundreds of millions to build what Indiana already owns.

SSI PROGRAM
INDIANA ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION
Strategic Sites Inventory · November 2026

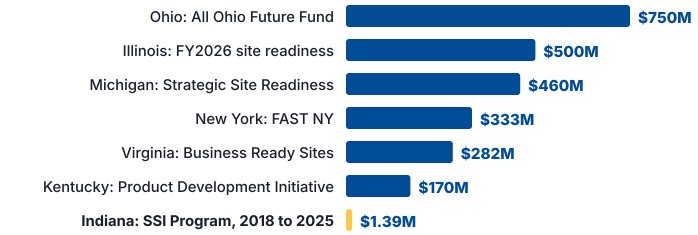
#1
site elimination factor in 2026: availability of development-ready sites (61% of site selectors)

76%
of site selectors name development-ready site availability a top factor shaping the industry

+20 pts
year-over-year jump in the weight of site readiness and due diligence status (Area Development 2026)

27+
states now fund site readiness, "a national arms race in site preparation funding"

WHAT OTHER STATES ARE PAYING TO BUILD



Committed site readiness funding since 2022, in millions. Most of it buys the identification and tiering Indiana completed for $1.39 million. Virginia, after $282 million and a string of wins, has one shovel-ready 250-acre site left.

WHAT INDIANA ALREADY OWNS

Sites identified, all 92 counties	1,811	Acres identified	235,402
Counties locally reviewed	74	Sites ranked 4.0 or higher	490
Sites ranked 5.0	141	Potential mega sites	70
Solar sites (10,142 MW)	38	Hyperscale data center candidates	58

Proof at the highest level: LEAP
IEDC markets the 9,000-acre LEAP Research and Innovation District as sitting "all on an SSI-certified (Strategic Site Inventory) site." The SSI team supported LEAP in 2021 and delivered the Boone County 3,099-acre Technology MegaSite in 2022. Eli Lilly has since committed $18 billion and Meta $10 billion there.

THE COST OF STANDING STILL

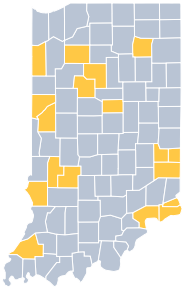
Inventory decay
Phase I data dates from 2018 to 2021. Ownership, zoning, solar conversion and data center absorption change conditions every year; rescreening stopped in 2024.

Partner momentum
Eight utilities and 92 LEDOs organized budgets and calendars around SSI. Phase II slowed when IEDC's budget ran out in July 2024; a cold restart costs more than continuity.

Lost projects
Site readiness is now the first screen. An unadvanced site fails it quietly and the state never learns it lost. One mid-size plant exceeds this whole program's cost.

Portal goes dark
IEDC called the SSI Portal "mission critical" for RFI response. Licenses lapsed June 2025; the system of record for 1,811 sites is unavailable to the people who answer prospects.

THE UNFINISHED JOB



18 counties never reviewed. Carroll, Cass, Clay, Fayette, Fountain, Franklin, Gibson, Jefferson, Newton, Ohio, Owen, Pulaski, Sullivan, Switzerland, Tipton, Union, Warren, Whitley.

9 of 490 top-ranked sites have Phase II due diligence. **0** have graduated to market under site control. Phase III costs $10,000 to $25,000 per site and requires no land purchase.

THE ASK: A THREE-YEAR INDIANA SSI SITE GRADUATION PROGRAM

A	**Complete and refresh the inventory** 18 remaining county workshops; rescreen 490 ranked sites	**$250K**	IEDC
B	**Phase II due diligence** 36 top-ranked sites, 12 per year	**$553K**	IEDC 50% / utilities 50%
C	**Phase III site advancement** Landowner engagement, purchase options, zoning, publication: first 18 sites	**$360K**	IEDC, LEDOs
D	**Signals-ready technical marketing** NAICS-code all 490 sites ranked 4.0+; profiles and brochures for top 100	**$400K**	IEDC 50% / utilities 50%
E	**SSI Portal and program management** Portal licenses, RFI support, reporting	**$375K**	IEDC, utility licenses

$1.94M
three-year program total; IEDC share about $1.46M, roughly $490K per year

0.26%
of Ohio's $750M site readiness commitment; about 1% of Indiana's $150M Site Acquisition Fund

18 sites
graduated under purchase option by year three; 45 with Phase II; 490 NAICS-coded and Signals-ready

THEN TURN THE INVENTORY INTO AN OUTBOUND ENGINE: SSI: SIGNALS

Ranked inventory
490 sites at 4.0+, 141 at 5.0, in the SSI Portal

NAICS-coded sites
Four-digit sector codes, acreage, utilities, labor shed, rank

SSI: Signals
AI monitors filings, permits, interconnect queues, hiring for expansion intent

Site-to-prospect match
Validated leads matched to specific Indiana sites by NAICS and infrastructure fit

Projects
Outreach months before a consultant RFI; leads without a site become site needs

PARTNERS READY TO CO-INVEST

Indiana Economic Development Corporation · Duke Energy Indiana · Wabash Valley Power Alliance · NIPSCO · Hoosier Energy · AES Indiana · CenterPoint Energy · Indiana Michigan Power · IMPA · 92 county LEDOs · 15 regional EDOs

Utilities funded Phase II at $10,000 per site and licensed portals through 2025; AES Indiana, 2024: "The Indiana SSI Program continues to achieve milestones and produce ROI." They followed IEDC into the pause and will follow IEDC out of it. **Decision requested:** authorize joint scoping within 60 days and renew SSI Portal access now.

LOCATION Design Group · SSI PROGRAM

Prepared by Victor Leotta, Location Design Group, LLC, an ATK Energy Group Company, creator of the SSI Program. (225) 281-4202.

Sources: Site Selectors Guild and DCI 2026 pulse check; Area Development Q1 2026; MEDC, JobsOhio, VEDP, Site Selection Group; IEDC LEAP and SSI pages; IEDC contracts and LL+D/LDG invoices 2018 to 2025; companion Case for Reinvestment.